

# RANSOMWARE ECOSYSTEM DISRUPTION FRAMEWORK

*Group Pressure Tracking Template*

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## HOW TO USE THIS TEMPLATE

This template is the operational instrument for group-level pressure tracking. When a working group initiates sustained operations against a specific ransomware actor or brand, this template is opened and populated from the start. It runs alongside the per-operation micro-layer log entries in the KPI framework.

The template serves two audiences: the operational team maintaining situational awareness on the target group, and leadership who need a pre/post picture of what specific pressure is producing against a specific actor.

### RELATIONSHIP TO THE KPI FRAMEWORK

This template sits between the micro layer (per-operation logs) and the meso layer (node cluster metrics) in the KPI framework architecture.

Micro-layer operation logs document individual actions against this group. This template aggregates those actions and tracks the cumulative effect on the target group specifically.

Meso-layer node metrics track ecosystem-wide pressure. This template tracks group-specific effects that contribute to those meso metrics.

Leadership receives this template as a group-level summary, not a node-level or ecosystem-level report.

## Population Instructions

- Open one template per active target group. Do not combine multiple groups in a single template.
- Populate Section 1 (Group Profile) before any pressure actions begin. This establishes the baseline.
- Populate Section 2 (Baseline Metrics) before any pressure actions begin. Baselines cannot be established retroactively.
- Update Section 3 (Pressure Action Log) after every action against this group.
- Update Section 4 (Observed Effects Tracker) at 30, 90, and 180-day intervals from the date of first action.
- Section 5 (WAIS Log) is populated only when an arrest occurs involving this group.
- Section 6 (Strife Event Log) is populated when any strife event type is observed.
- Section 7 (Assessment) is completed at each 90-day review cycle.

## SECTION 1 | GROUP PROFILE

Populate before operations begin. Update when material changes are observed.

|                           |                                                                              |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Group Name / Handle       | Primary name and known aliases                                               |
| Template ID               | Unique identifier for this tracking file                                     |
| Date Opened               | Date this template was initiated                                             |
| Owning Team / Agency      | Primary team responsible for population                                      |
| Operational Model         | RaaS franchise / Closed hierarchical / Independent affiliate / Other         |
| Estimated Active Since    | Approximate date of first confirmed activity                                 |
| Lineage                   | Known predecessor groups or personnel origins (e.g., former Conti operators) |
| Estimated Affiliate Count | Point-in-time estimate at template opening. Confidence level.                |
| Primary RaaS Platform     | If applicable: Exploit, XSS, private recruitment, or other                   |
| Known Operating Geography | Primary actor geography based on available intelligence                      |

### Node Exposure Assessment

For each ecosystem node, assess the target group's current dependency and known infrastructure. This drives which nodes to prioritize for pressure.

| Node                         | Dependency Level              | Known Infrastructure / Actors | Substitutability    | Priority |
|------------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------|----------|
| Node 01: OTC Brokers         | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |
| Node 02: High-Risk Exchanges | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |
| Node 03: BPH                 | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |
| Node 04: IAB Markets         | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |
| Node 05: Botnet/Loaders      | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |
| Node 06: Leak Site           | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |

| Node                       | Dependency Level              | Known Infrastructure / Actors | Substitutability    | Priority |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|---------------------|----------|
| Node 07: Underground Trust | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |
| Node 08: Mixers            | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |
| Node 09: Mule Networks     | High / Medium / Low / Unknown |                               | High / Medium / Low |          |

Protection Layer Assessment

|                            |                                                                             |
|----------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Krysha Relationship Status | Active / Strained / Broken / Unknown / None Assessed                        |
| Assessed Protecting Entity | FSB unit / officer / MVD / Other / Unknown. Move specifics to Tier 3 annex. |
| Confidence Level           | CONFIRMED / CREDIBLE / INDICATIVE                                           |
| Protection Evidence Basis  | Brief description of evidence basis. Full sourcing in controlled annex.     |
| Backfire Risk Assessment   | Low / Medium / High. Reference companion playbook engagement triggers.      |

## SECTION 2 | BASELINE METRICS

Establish before any pressure actions begin. These are the pre-action reference points against which all observed effects will be measured. A baseline that cannot be established is marked UNKNOWN, not estimated.

### BASELINE INTEGRITY RULE

Baselines must be established before the first action. Retroactive baseline establishment is not permitted because actions may already have affected the indicators. If a baseline cannot be established before action commences, mark it UNKNOWN and note the date of first action. Future measurements will be relative to the first post-action observation, which must be clearly labeled as such.

### Operational Tempo Baseline

| Metric                                                         | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| Leak site post volume (monthly average, 90-day window)         |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Average time-to-publish (days from compromise to publication)  |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Estimated active affiliate count                               |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Average ransom demand (USD, reported cases)                    |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Victim payment rate (confirmed payments / confirmed incidents) |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Average ransom demand fulfillment rate                         |                       |        |        |         |            |

### Financial Infrastructure Baseline

| Metric                                                            | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| Primary OTC broker nodes (count of identified)                    |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Attributed wallet cluster activity (monthly volume, USD estimate) |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Primary mixing service usage (identified services)                |                       |        |        |         |            |
| OFAC-designated wallet percentage (of attributed wallets)         |                       |        |        |         |            |

### Access and Delivery Infrastructure Baseline

| Metric                                                     | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| IAB sourcing pattern (primary forums and volume)           |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Average IAB access cost (USD, by access type if available) |                       |        |        |         |            |
| BPH provider count (identified hosting nodes)              |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Loader/botnet dependency (primary delivery mechanism)      |                       |        |        |         |            |

Underground Trust and Forum Health Baseline

| Metric                                                        | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| Forum reputation score (Exploit/XSS, if available)            |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Active dispute threads against group on monitored forums      |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Affiliate recruitment activity (posts per month, approximate) |                       |        |        |         |            |
| Current affiliate split percentage (advertised)               |                       |        |        |         |            |

SECTION 3 | PRESSURE ACTION LOG

Add one row per action targeting this group. Cross-reference the operation ID to the micro-layer log entry in the KPI framework. Do not duplicate the full micro-layer log here: record the action type, expected effect, and reference the micro-layer entry for detail.

| Date | Operation ID | Action Type                                                                                        | Target Node(s) | Expected Primary Effect (30 days) | Backfire Risk          | Micro-Layer Log Ref |
|------|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------|---------------------|
|      |              | Designation /<br>Takedown /<br>Sinkhole / Referral<br>/ Arrest /<br>Journalism /<br>Infrastructure |                |                                   | Low /<br>Med /<br>High |                     |
|      |              |                                                                                                    |                |                                   |                        |                     |
|      |              |                                                                                                    |                |                                   |                        |                     |
|      |              |                                                                                                    |                |                                   |                        |                     |
|      |              |                                                                                                    |                |                                   |                        |                     |
|      |              |                                                                                                    |                |                                   |                        |                     |

SECTION 4 | OBSERVED EFFECTS TRACKER

Update at 30, 90, and 180 days from the date of first action. Compare against baselines in Section 2. Annotate any divergence from expected effects.

4.1 Operational Tempo Effects

| Metric                              | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| Leak site post volume vs. baseline  | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Time-to-publish vs. baseline        | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Active affiliate count vs. baseline | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Average ransom demand vs. baseline  | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Victim payment rate vs. baseline    | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |

4.2 Financial Infrastructure Effects

| Metric                                    | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| OTC broker nodes active vs. baseline      | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Attributed wallet activity vs. baseline   | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Mixing service usage vs. baseline         | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Designated wallet percentage vs. baseline | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |

4.3 Access and Delivery Effects

| Metric                                       | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|----------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| IAB access costs vs. baseline                | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| BPH provider count vs. baseline              | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Loader/botnet delivery capacity vs. baseline | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |

4.4 Underground Trust Effects

| Metric                            | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| Forum dispute volume vs. baseline | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |



| Metric                                      | Baseline (Pre-Action) | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| Affiliate recruitment activity vs. baseline | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| Affiliate split percentage vs. baseline     | See Section 2         |        |        |         |            |
| New brand/splinter emergence                | None at baseline      |        |        |         |            |

4.5 Divergence Notes

Record any significant divergence between expected and observed effects here. Include the operation ID, the expected effect, what was actually observed, and a brief assessment of why the divergence occurred.

| Date | Operation ID | Expected Effect | Observed Effect | Divergence Assessment |
|------|--------------|-----------------|-----------------|-----------------------|
|      |              |                 |                 |                       |
|      |              |                 |                 |                       |
|      |              |                 |                 |                       |

SECTION 5 | WAIS LOG

Populate when an arrest involving this group occurs. Score each arrest individually. Reference the full WAIS scoring guide in the KPI framework document, Section 6.

| Field                                          | Arrest 1 | Arrest 2 | Arrest 3 |
|------------------------------------------------|----------|----------|----------|
| Operation ID / Date                            |          |          |          |
| Actor Role / Node<br>Criticality Score (1/2/3) |          |          |          |
| Cooperation Output Score<br>(1/2/3 or PENDING) |          |          |          |
| Trust Cascade Effect<br>Score (1/2/3)          |          |          |          |
| Reconstitution Impact<br>Score (1/2/3)         |          |          |          |
| WAIS Total                                     |          |          |          |
| Coordination Bonus<br>Applied (+2)?            |          |          |          |
| Final WAIS (with bonus if<br>applicable)       |          |          |          |
| WAIS Category<br>(High/Moderate/Limited)       |          |          |          |
| 90-Day Update Required?                        | Yes / No | Yes / No | Yes / No |

Cooperation Output PENDING follow-up:

| Arrest ID | PENDING Since | Debrief Expected Date | Update When Available |
|-----------|---------------|-----------------------|-----------------------|
|           |               |                       |                       |
|           |               |                       |                       |

SECTION 6 | STRIFE EVENT LOG

Populate when any strife event is observed involving this group. Use the event types defined in the KPI framework Section 5.2. Each event gets one row. Add rows as needed.

| Date | Event Type                                                                                   | Source Reliability                | Description | Ecosystem Effect Observed | Causal Link to Actions | Follow-On Indicators to Watch |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|-------------|---------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|
|      | LEAK / PUBLIC DISPUTE / EXIT SCAM / DEFECTION / ARR-TRIGGERED FRAG / HANDLER COMPLAINT / DOX | CONFIRMED / CREDIBLE / INDICATIVE |             |                           |                        |                               |
|      |                                                                                              |                                   |             |                           |                        |                               |
|      |                                                                                              |                                   |             |                           |                        |                               |

SECTION 7 | ASSESSMENT

Complete at each 90-day review cycle. This is the leadership-reportable summary for this group. One page maximum. Designed for Tier 1 leadership dashboard use.

7.1 Current Group Status

|                                   |                                                                              |
|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Assessment Date                   |                                                                              |
| Overall Group Status              | Fully Operational / Degraded / Significantly Degraded / Inactive / Dissolved |
| Operational Capacity vs. Baseline | Percentage estimate with confidence label                                    |
| Financial Rail Status             | Intact / Partially Disrupted / Significantly Disrupted                       |
| Protection Layer Status           | Active / Strained / Broken / Unknown                                         |
| Reconstitution Risk               | Low / Medium / High. If high, what is enabling reconstitution?               |

7.2 Pressure Effect Summary

In plain language, what has the pressure campaign produced? What is working, what is not, and what is the next recommended action. Three to five sentences maximum.

7.3 Recommended Next Actions

| Priority | Recommended Action | Target Node | Expected Effect | Owner |
|----------|--------------------|-------------|-----------------|-------|
| 1        |                    |             |                 |       |
| 2        |                    |             |                 |       |
| 3        |                    |             |                 |       |

7.4 KPI Framework Feed

Which macro and meso-layer KPIs are updated by this assessment? List the specific metrics and the direction of movement.

| KPI ID | KPI Name | Direction of Movement                   | Confidence | Notes |
|--------|----------|-----------------------------------------|------------|-------|
|        |          | Improving /<br>Worsening / No<br>Change |            |       |
|        |          |                                         |            |       |
|        |          |                                         |            |       |
|        |          |                                         |            |       |

# ANNEX A | EXAMPLE: RANSOMLOOKER PRE-POPULATION (RansomHub)

This annex shows what a partially populated template looks like for an active group. RansomHub is used as the example because it is well-documented in open-source reporting and represents the current dominant franchise post-LockBit. This is illustrative only: all data drawn from public sources, and fields that require operational intelligence are left blank.

## Section 1 Partial: Group Profile

|                           |                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Group Name / Handle       | RansomHub                                                                                                                                            |
| Template ID               | EXAMPLE-RH-001                                                                                                                                       |
| Date Opened               | March 2026 (illustrative)                                                                                                                            |
| Operational Model         | RaaS franchise. Open affiliate recruitment. High affiliate split (90/10 in favor of affiliate).                                                      |
| Estimated Active Since    | February 2024. Emerged rapidly post-LockBit Operation Cronos.                                                                                        |
| Lineage                   | Assessed to include former LockBit and BlackCat/ALPHV affiliates. Possible Scattered Spider overlap per open-source reporting. Confidence: CREDIBLE. |
| Estimated Affiliate Count | Unknown. Recruiting aggressively. Assessed high based on attack volume. Confidence: INDICATIVE.                                                      |
| Primary RaaS Platform     | Private. Affiliate recruitment via underground forums (Exploit, XSS) and direct outreach.                                                            |

## Section 2 Partial: Operational Tempo Baseline (Illustrative)

NOTE

The following baseline values are drawn from open-source leak site tracking data (Ransomlook, Ransomware.live) and public reporting. They are illustrative of what a baseline entry looks like, not operational intelligence.

| Metric                                           | Baseline (Pre-Action)                          | 30-Day | 90-Day | 180-Day | Confidence |
|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|--------|--------|---------|------------|
| Leak site post volume (monthly average, Q4 2024) | ~75-100 victims/month (open source)            |        |        |         | CREDIBLE   |
| Average time-to-publish                          | ~3-5 days post-compromise (estimated)          |        |        |         | INDICATIVE |
| Estimated active affiliate count                 | Unknown. High volume suggests large roster.    |        |        |         | INDICATIVE |
| Average ransom demand                            | Variable. High-value targets reported at \$1M+ |        |        |         | CREDIBLE   |

## What a Pressure Campaign Against RansomHub Would Track

Given RansomHub's position as the current dominant franchise and its absorption of former LockBit and BlackCat affiliates, a pressure campaign would prioritize:

- Node 01 (OTC Brokers): identify and designate the OTC nodes serving RansomHub admin wallet cash-out. RansomHub's 90/10 affiliate split means admin wallet flows are smaller proportionally but still significant at volume.
- Node 04 (IAB Markets): monitor affiliate purchasing patterns. Price sensitivity is high given the 90/10 split leaves thinner admin margins. Access cost increases compress admin revenue faster than in a 70/30 model.
- Node 07 (Underground Trust): RansomHub's reputation for reliable affiliate payments is its primary recruitment differentiator post-LockBit. Disrupting that reputation through escrow failures or dispute seeding is a high-value trust infrastructure action.
- Strife monitoring: watch for any affiliate complaints about non-payment or delayed payment. Given the composition of former LockBit and BlackCat affiliates (who already experienced one exit scam), trust tolerance is lower than in a more established group. Early strife indicators will surface faster.

*RANSOMWARE ECOSYSTEM DISRUPTION FRAMEWORK: GROUP PRESSURE TRACKING TEMPLATE v0.1 — March 2026*

*Working Document — Handle Per Originating Agency Protocols — One Template Per Active Target Group*